INVESTOR MEMORANDUM · SUMMER 2026 · CONFIDENTIAL

Economic impact analysis, rebuilt as software.

Lumecon is building software-first economic impact infrastructure for governments, tribal nations, enterprises, consultants, and mission-driven organizations.

Lumecon Inc. · A Delaware Corporation · lumecon.ai

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Executive Summary

Lumecon is the software platform that makes economic impact analysis accessible to the organizations the current market underserves. The category is proven, the entry point is the most technically demanding segment of it, and the underlying technology shift makes building this company possible now in a way it was not five years ago.

The company is currently raising up to $100,000 in SAFE financing at a $5,000,000 post-money valuation cap to accelerate product development, pilot implementation, intellectual property protection, and commercialization. The founders have personally committed $50,000 in capital, with $25,000 already deployed.

INSTRUMENT	VALUATION CAP	RAISE TARGET
Y Combinator SAFE Post-money, no discount	$5.0M Post-money	Up to $100K SAFE financing
FOUNDER COMMITTED	FOUNDER DEPLOYED	ENTITY
$50K Personal capital	$25K Already deployed	Delaware C-Corp Founded January 2026

WHY NOW

Why Now

Three things converged in the last 24 months that make this company possible to build now.

AI can do the repetitive part of professional knowledge work. Recent labor-economics research finds that the share of professional work theoretically exposed to current AI systems substantially exceeds what is being adopted in practice.[1] Economic impact analysis sits in that gap. The binding constraint in the category has never been modeling capacity. It has been the human time spent reading source documents, harmonizing inputs against public datasets, naming and tracking every assumption, and writing the same kind of paragraph and chart again on every engagement. That sequence is exactly the kind of work current AI systems do well and current institutions trust only when each step is reviewable.

Existing providers have not modernized. IMPLAN and REMI operate on workflows that predate the cloud.[2] The market leaders prove demand and validate willingness to pay, but their stacks were built when desktop software was the assumption. The gap between what current technology can support and what shipped product offers is unusually wide.

Customers want experts plus AI, not black-box outputs. Governments, tribes, foundations, and grantmakers cannot accept a number they cannot defend. Lumecon sits between AI-only tools and traditional consultants. AI handles intake, harmonization, and drafting; the analyst stays accountable for every assumption.

This is not a "use AI for X" story. It is a "modernize a stagnant category" story where AI is one of several enabling shifts.

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

Market Opportunity

Existing providers prove willingness to pay. They do not define the boundary of the market.

THE WEDGE

575

Federally Recognized Tribes

One of the most technically difficult economic environments in the United States.[3]

12 + ~225

Alaska Native Corporations

12 regional corporations and roughly 225 village corporations, operating across unique ownership and governance structures.[4]

THE BROADER MARKET

PUBLIC SECTOR

90,837 U.S. local governments[5a]
3,144 counties and county equivalents[5b]
~19,500 incorporated cities, towns, and villages[5c]
50 states

INSTITUTIONS

4,150 degree-granting colleges and universities[7]
1.9M+ registered U.S. nonprofits[6a]
Tens of thousands of larger public charities above $1M in revenue[6b]

PRIVATE SECTOR

2M+ employer firms with 5 or more employees[8]
Consulting firms serving governments, nonprofits, universities, and foundations
Economic-development organizations

> Lumecon is built for the much larger set of organizations that currently do not participate in the market.

IMPLAN publicly reports more than 900 client organizations, and REMI has long served public agencies, universities, and consultants on the state and federal side.[9] In 2024, Charlesbank Capital Partners acquired a controlling stake in IMPLAN for more than $100 million, with the Wall Street Journal reporting that IMPLAN had grown revenue at more than 35% annually over the prior three years.[10] That transaction is the cleanest available evidence that the category attracts institutional capital and that demand is durable.

Most of the organizations above have never run an economic impact study because the practical cost of one can exceed $25,000 and, in more complex engagements, approach or exceed $100,000 once software, consulting, and internal staff time are added together.[11] Lumecon's pricing structure breaks below that floor and turns one-time studies into a continuously refreshed planning tool.

The same measurement problem exists globally. Subnational governments worldwide manage 40% of public expenditures and 58% of public investment in OECD countries.[13] UCLG's network represents local and regional governments across more than 140 countries.[14] Lumecon's long-run opportunity extends to governments, NGOs, foundations, development organizations, and multinational firms operating across borders.

THE PROBLEM

The Problem

Economic impact analysis today is a months-long, labor-bound project with a five-figure-per-study price tag. A consultant is hired or a desktop license is opened. Data is collected by hand from spreadsheets, PDFs, and emails. Inputs are cleaned and harmonized manually. Multipliers are picked one by one. Assumptions are typed into the report margin. Charts are built by hand. A senior analyst writes the report; a junior one keys the model. The deck is formatted overnight. Revisions take a week each. Every refresh starts the cycle over and is billed again. The legacy stack charges per geography, per user, per data tier; the consultants who operate it bill by the hour. Update cycles bring the bill back every time the data needs to move.

Lumecon collapses both layers. One annual subscription. Unlimited studies. Every geography included. Cedar reads the source documents, surfaces every modeling assumption for analyst sign-off, drafts the narrative against the customer's own template, and exports a branded deliverable on demand. The analyst spends time on the judgment calls; the platform handles the mechanics. Refresh quarterly without reopening a contract.

WHY TRIBES FIRST

Why Tribes First

Tribal economies are among the most difficult economic environments to model accurately in the United States. Reservations, off-reservation trust lands, overlapping jurisdictions, sovereign governments, rural geography, Alaska Native Corporation regions, Native Hawaiian Home Lands, and Indigenous data sovereignty requirements together create a problem that the major incumbents handle by approximating reservations as counties and hoping nobody asks.

Solving these problems first creates infrastructure that deploys directly into broader markets. The geographic engine, the data sovereignty controls, the institutional flexibility, and the multi-jurisdictional reasoning are exactly what cities, foundations, federal agencies, and international clients need. Tribes are the strategically right entry point because they force the hardest version of the problem to be solved first.

Incumbents handle this category today by approximating reservations as counties and routing tribal customers through the same workflow they sell to a state DOT. Lumecon does not. The modeling infrastructure required to do this correctly (sovereign-government geographies, ANC and trust-land jurisdictions, Indigenous data sovereignty controls, complex-geography aware multipliers) is exactly the kind of investment a desktop vendor is unlikely to make for a segment they already serve poorly. The asymmetry is the moat.

An internal review of public tribal impact studies between 2000 and 2026 identified 50+ published reports across more than two dozen tribal organizations, several of which commissioned studies repeatedly.[12] That recurring footprint is the early-customer base that funds the broader expansion.

PRODUCT

Product

Three regional platforms on one engine. One modeling backbone. One three-tier ladder (Sprout, Sapling, Tree). The platform stack progresses from the foundational regional products today to the cross-border layer launching in 2028.

Global Economic Impact	Cross-border, supply-chain, and multinational analysis. Launches 2028.
Cedar Grove	Organizational intelligence layer; harmonized customer memory across studies. Launches 2027.
Cedar	AI workflow for source intake, harmonization, and assumption tracking. Ships inside Sapling and Tree.
Local + Tribal Economic Impact	The two regional platforms shipping in 2026. Shared modeling engine, shared tier ladder.

Cedar. Lumecon's AI-assisted workflow. Cedar uploads and processes data in PDF, CSV, and XLSX formats today, with more formats expanding over time. It structures inputs against public data sources, surfaces every modeling assumption for human sign-off, and acts as a thought partner on the write-up. Cedar is not a ghostwriter. The analyst stays accountable for the substance.

Underneath the AI workflow Lumecon runs a regional input-output engine in the RIMS II / IMPLAN-class tradition, re-parameterized for complex jurisdictions and recompiled on each refresh. Cedar's value is not that it replaces that engine; it is that it threads source documents into the engine and threads the engine's outputs back into a deliverable an analyst can defend in front of a council, a board, or a federal program officer.

01 Source intake
Drop PDFs, CSVs, and XLSX files. Cedar extracts and types every field.

›

02 Harmonize
Inputs match against public datasets. Geographies, sectors, and time windows resolve automatically.

›

03 Assumption ledger
Every modeling choice surfaces for analyst review. Override, annotate, or approve in place.

›

04 Deliverable
Report, deck, and executive summary export branded to the customer with the assumption record attached.

Cedar's workflow. Each step is auditable; the analyst signs off on every assumption before the deliverable exports.

IMPACT BRIEF ILLUSTRATIVE

JOBS 12,400 direct + indirect + induced	LABOR INCOME $840M annual
OUTPUT $1.6B annual	STATE + LOCAL TAX $73M annual

ASSUMPTION LEDGER · CEDAR

Multiplier source RIMS II (2022)	APPROVED
Geographic basis Reservation + buffer counties	OVERRIDE
Sector mapping NAICS 6-digit	APPROVED
Employment elasticity 0.45	REVIEW

Illustrative. Real outputs include direct, indirect, and induced impacts and a full audit trail of every modeling assumption Cedar surfaces for analyst sign-off before export.

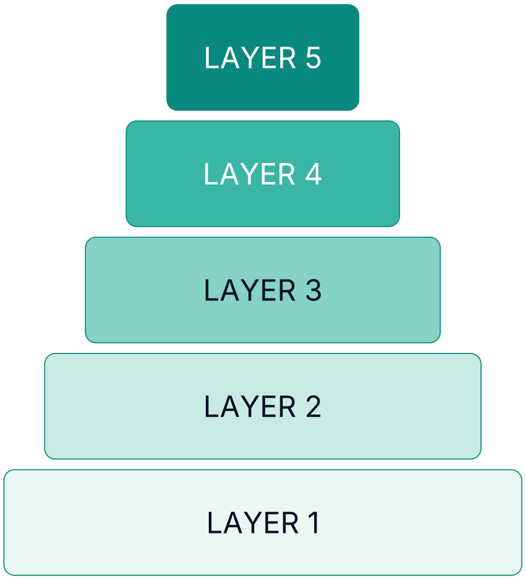
Cedar Grove. Launches in 2027 as the organizational intelligence layer. Customer data stays harmonized across every study a customer runs. Complementary administrative datasets (employment shifts, business openings and closures, wage movements, transfer-payment flows) sit alongside the customer's own data, so each study reinforces the impact narrative with real outcome evidence rather than only modeled multipliers. Recurring submissions (grants, federal reporting, audited annual reports) start from a base that already passed review.

Arborist and Toolbox. Arborist is the consultant plan, project-based, $15,000 flat for two projects in one engagement, renewable as a fresh engagement when those wrap up. Toolbox is a $15,000 add-on that pairs the platform with our team for finished publication-ready deliverables.

THE MOAT

The Moat

The defensibility is layered, and each layer compounds on the one below it.



Privacy-preserving learning
Future federated learning architecture. Models improve across customers without raw data ever leaving.

Cedar Grove and switching costs
Harmonized data, source library, assumption history. The longer a customer stays, the more expensive switching gets.

Reusable data infrastructure
Clean and harmonize public, alternative, and administrative data once. Every customer benefits.

Complex-geography engine
Reservations, trust lands, congressional districts, watersheds, and multi-jurisdictional regions as first-class geographies.

Tribal and Native-economy expertise
Direct experience from the Federal Reserve CICD, NCAI, and the Native Entity Enterprise dataset. Hard to acquire.

Patents, trademarks, copyrights, and trade secret protections sit on top of these layers as a procedural moat, not the primary one.

ROADMAP

Roadmap

2026	2027	2028
Local Economic Impact County, state, national coverage Tribal Economic Impact Reservation, county, state, national Cedar AI workflow inside Sapling and Tree tiers	Cedar Grove Organizational intelligence layer on Tree	Global Economic Impact Cross-border and supply-chain analysis

REVENUE MODEL

Revenue Model

Local Economic Impact

SPROUT	SAPLING	TREE
$7,500	$15,000	$20,000
County coverage. One study workspace.	State and national coverage. Unlimited studies.	Cedar AI workflow included. Custom branding on exports.

Tribal Economic Impact

SPROUT
$10,000
Reservation coverage. One study workspace.

SAPLING
$17,500
All geographies. Unlimited studies.

TREE
$25,000
Cedar AI workflow. Cedar Grove ready. Custom branding.

Offering	Price	Detail
Arborist	$15,000 flat	For consulting firms running studies on outside clients. Two projects in one engagement, renewable as a fresh engagement.
Toolbox	$15,000 add-on	Team-produced finished deliverables (report, deck, executive summary, source record, assumption ledger). Three rounds of revisions. Pairs with Tree so deliverables pick up the customer's custom branding automatically.

First subscriptions and pilots begin in 2026. The company is targeting first paid revenue by end of 2026 from a focused set of Tribal and Local pilots in priority geographies.

USE OF FUNDS

Use of Funds

Contractors $50,000 · 50%
Six months of work. Economist, two data scientists, and software engineer at 8 to 12 hours a week.

Legal, compliance, IP $30,000 · 30%
Corporate governance, customer contracting, financing documentation, patents, trademarks, and copyrights.

Infrastructure $10,000 · 10%
Cloud computing, storage, monitoring, and security.

Marketing, customer acquisition, piloting $10,000 · 10%
Pilot implementation, customer onboarding, sales, and marketing.

CURRENT PROGRESS

Current Progress

The company is past the concept stage. Capital is deployed, legal counsel is engaged, the product timeline is mapped, and the public commercial surface is live.

FOUNDER CAPITAL $50K committed, $25K deployed Funding contractor work, infrastructure, and incorporation	FELLOWSHIP SUPPORT $6K awarded [FELLOWSHIP NAME] (placeholder, to confirm)	LEGAL ENGAGEMENT Cornell Law Entrepreneurship Clinic Corporate, IP, and customer contracting in active workstream
PRODUCT TIMELINE MVP end of June 2026 Local and Tribal Economic Impact platforms launch end of 2026	STRATEGIC OUTREACH Early conversations underway Native American Contractors Association (NACA) as a priority early relationship	COMMERCIAL SURFACE lumecon.ai live Public product positioning, pricing, and inbound capture

TEAM

Team

Investors invest in teams. This one is the strongest part of the company.

CO-FOUNDER & CEO
Elijah Moreno, MPP
Cornell PhD candidate. Dartmouth Economics. Federal Reserve CICD. NCAI Mankiller Fellow. Native Entity Enterprise dataset.

CO-FOUNDER & FOUNDING INVESTOR
Michael Moreno
Moved the company from concept to product through founding capital and early-stage support.

ECONOMICS LEAD
Laurel Wheeler, PhD
Duke PhD in Economics. Oxford MSc. Federal Reserve CICD economist. Native CDFI lending researcher.

INPUT/OUTPUT ENGINE LEAD
Isabella Agnes
Wisconsin Math + Economics. Maryland doctoral. Federal Reserve Board. Federal Reserve Philadelphia.

CEDAR LEAD
Francesca Agnes
Illinois Urbana-Champaign. Leads Cedar, the AI assistant for source intake and assumption tracking.

PLATFORM LEAD
Kaylyn Lee
Cornell Computer Science with Business. Leads the customer-facing platform end to end.

ADVISORS

ADVISOR	ADVISOR	ADVISOR
Vod Vilfort Methodology Advisor MIT PhD candidate in econometrics. Yale Economics and Mathematics. AER: Insights, 2025.	**Brian Kim** Technical Advisor Dartmouth Economics. Senior engineer at Modsy and Chime. Architecture, Cedar, and security.	**Havala Hanson, PhD** Product & Data Security Advisor Alaska Fairbanks PhD in Statistics. Brown MA. Data governance for sensitive administrative datasets.

CORNELL · DARTMOUTH · YALE · DUKE · MIT · OXFORD · BROWN · UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN–MADISON · UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND · UNIVERSITY OF ALASKA FAIRBANKS · FEDERAL RESERVE SYSTEM · CENTER FOR INDIAN COUNTRY DEVELOPMENT

RISK FACTORS

Risk Factors

Material risks the company has identified and the mitigations in place. This is not a complete enumeration; the full SAFE risk-factor schedule will accompany the appended SAFE document.

CONCENTRATION

Early customer base will be small and segment-focused.

MITIGATION

Tribal customers commission studies repeatedly, and the same engine deploys directly into the broader local, federal, and international markets.

EXECUTION

Small team operating on limited capital against a multi-year roadmap.

MITIGATION

Founder capital extends runway, contractor model keeps burn predictable, and the team's domain expertise compresses the learning curve.

DATA SOVEREIGNTY

Tribal data, federal datasets, and administrative data carry sovereignty and compliance requirements.

MITIGATION

Data governance is built into the architecture from day one, with on-premise and federated learning options.

INCUMBENT RESPONSE

Charlesbank's IMPLAN investment may accelerate the incumbent's modernization.

MITIGATION

Lumecon's complex-geography engine, Cedar workflow, and Cedar Grove cannot be retrofitted into desktop software; they have to be rebuilt.

MODEL ACCURACY AND AUDIT

AI error in a credibility-sensitive workflow is the central product risk.

MITIGATION

Cedar surfaces every modeling assumption for human sign-off before a deliverable exports. The analyst stays accountable for the substance.

CLOSING

Closing

Economic impact analysis is a proven category with stagnant incumbents, a customer base limited by price rather than need, and an underlying technology shift that makes the next generation of platforms possible to build. The strategically correct entry point is the segment that current providers handle worst, which is tribal economies and the complex geographies that come with them. Solving for that segment produces infrastructure that deploys directly into the rest of the market.

The question is no longer whether economic impact analysis matters. The question is who has access to it.

The full SAFE form will be attached as an appendix in the final send version.

SAFE TERMS

INSTRUMENT Y Combinator post-money SAFE	VALUATION CAP $5,000,000 post-money	RAISE TARGET Up to $100,000
DISCOUNT None	MFN Standard	PRO RATA Side letter on request

Make the economically invisible visible.

LUMECON INC. · LUMECON.AI · SUMMER 2026

REFERENCES

References

1 Eloundou, T., Manning, S., Mishkin, P., & Rock, D. (2023). "GPTs are GPTs: An Early Look at the Labor Market Impact Potential of Large Language Models." OpenAI / Penn / OpenResearch working paper. arXiv:2303.10130.

2 IMPLAN and REMI product documentation and release notes, accessed 2025–2026. Both vendors ship desktop-installed software with cloud companions added in the last 24 months.

3 Bureau of Indian Affairs, Tribal Leaders Directory and "Indian Entities Recognized by and Eligible To Receive Services From the United States Bureau of Indian Affairs," Federal Register, January 30, 2026. 575 federally recognized tribes.

4 Alaska Native Regional Corporations (12) per ANCSA Regional Association; approximately 225 village corporations per the Resource Development Council for Alaska / ANCSA Regional Association.

5a Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, "The Number and Type of Local Governments in the U.S.," 2024, citing the 2022 Census of Governments. 90,837 U.S. local governments.

5b U.S. Census Bureau, 2022 Census of Governments and OECD Local Data Portal methodology. 3,144 counties and county-equivalents; 3,031 county governments.

5c U.S. Census Bureau, "Incorporated places in the United States." Approximately 19,500 incorporated places.

6a Candid, "Money in the U.S. Social Sector," accessed 2025–2026. Approximately 1.9M registered U.S. nonprofits.

6b Nonprofit Impact Matters, downloadable data charts: 92% of U.S. nonprofits operate with annual revenue under $1M; the remainder (a large public-charity universe in the tens of thousands) is the relevant segment for paid impact studies.

7 National Science Foundation / NCSES, U.S. institutions providing science and engineering higher education, 2019–20: approximately 4,150 degree-granting institutions. NCES / IES reports 5,819 Title IV institutions for 2023–24.

8 U.S. Census Bureau, Statistics of U.S. Businesses (SUSB), 2022 annual data. Approximately 2M employer firms with five or more employees. Distribution per Pew Research, "A Look at Small Businesses in the U.S.," April 2024.

9 IMPLAN, "IMPLAN Announces...," press release via PRNewswire, 2024 ("technology serves more than 900 clients"). REMI customer base referenced via REMI public materials, accessed 2025–2026.

10 Wall Street Journal, coverage of Charlesbank Capital Partners' 2024 acquisition of a controlling stake in IMPLAN for more than $100 million; reported IMPLAN revenue growth above 35% annually over the prior three years. Charlesbank Capital Partners press release, "Charlesbank Capital Partners Acquires IMPLAN," 2024.

11 Estimated from public IMPLAN and REMI list pricing, federal and state RFP awards for impact analysis contracts, and consultant rate cards. Includes software license, consulting hours, and internal staff time. Internal estimate; ranges vary by scope and geography.

12 Internal Lumecon dataset of publicly available tribal economic impact studies, 2000–2026. Compiled from tribal government and tribal enterprise public filings and consultant reports. Internal estimate.

13 OECD, "Subnational finance and investment," 2022 figures: subnational governments account for 40% of public expenditures and 58% of public investment in OECD countries.

14 United Cities and Local Governments (UCLG) network description and OECD/UCLG World Observatory on Subnational Government Finance (2022 edition covers 135 countries representing 93% of world population and 94% of global GDP).